

Module 11 Lab Session 2: JWT Bearer Authentication & Refresh Token Rotation

Session 2 of 3

Exercises Exercise 3 & Exercise 4

Integrity Lab tier **Tier 2** — JWT claim claims, HMAC-SHA256 signature, AddJwtBearer authentication, RefreshToken entity, rotation, single-use validation

Story thread

When a user submits valid credentials to `/api/auth/login`, the API must issue a cryptographically signed JSON Web Token (JWT) containing user identity claims (sub, email, role). Short-lived access tokens (15 minutes) reduce the impact of token theft. To maintain continuous user sessions, you will implement **Refresh Token Rotation**: every refresh call invalidates the old token (`IsUsed = true`) and issues a brand-new pair. Submitting an already-used refresh token triggers **token theft detection** and revokes all active sessions for that user.

Exercise 3: JWT Generation & Bearer Authentication Pipeline

Step 1: Configure Jwt Settings & User Secrets

In `appsettings.Development.json`:

```
{
  "Jwt": {
    "Issuer": "https://localhost:5001",
    "Audience": "tms-client",
    "ExpiryMinutes": 15
  }
}
```

Store the cryptographic signing key safely in User Secrets:

```
dotnet user-secrets set "Jwt:Key" "A-Very-Long-Secret-Key-For-TMS-Auth-
Stored-Safely-2026"
```

Step 2: Implement TokenService

Create TmsApi.Infrastructure/Services/TokenService.cs:

```
namespace TmsApi.Infrastructure.Services;

public class TokenService
{
    private readonly IConfiguration _config;

    public TokenService(IConfiguration config)
    {
        _config = config;
    }

    public string GenerateJwt(TmsUser user, IList<string> roles)
    {
        var claims = new List<Claim>
        {
            new Claim(ClaimTypes.NameIdentifier, user.Id),
            new Claim(ClaimTypes.Email, user.Email ?? string.Empty),
            new Claim("FirstName", user.FirstName)
        };

        foreach (var role in roles)
        {
            claims.Add(new Claim(ClaimTypes.Role, role));
        }

        var key = new
        SymmetricSecurityKey(Encoding.UTF8.GetBytes(_config["Jwt:Key"]!));
        var creds = new SigningCredentials(key,
        SecurityAlgorithms.HmacSha256);

        var token = new JwtSecurityToken(
            issuer: _config["Jwt:Issuer"],
            audience: _config["Jwt:Audience"],
            claims: claims,
            expires:
        DateTime.UtcNow.AddMinutes(int.Parse(_config["Jwt:ExpiryMinutes"]!)),
            signingCredentials: creds
        );

        return new JwtSecurityTokenHandler().WriteToken(token);
    }
}
```

Step 3: Configure Authentication Pipeline in Program.cs

In Program.cs, add JWT Bearer authentication and register TokenService:

```
builder.Services.AddScoped<TokenService>();

builder.Services.AddAuthentication(options =>
{
    options.DefaultAuthenticateScheme =
JwtBearerDefaults.AuthenticationScheme;
    options.DefaultChallengeScheme =
JwtBearerDefaults.AuthenticationScheme;
})
.AddJwtBearer(options =>
{
    options.TokenValidationParameters = new TokenValidationParameters
    {
        ValidateIssuer = true,
        ValidateAudience = true,
        ValidateLifetime = true,
        ValidateIssuerSigningKey = true,
        ValidIssuer = builder.Configuration["Jwt:Issuer"],
        ValidAudience = builder.Configuration["Jwt:Audience"],
        IssuerSigningKey = new SymmetricSecurityKey(
            Encoding.UTF8.GetBytes(builder.Configuration["Jwt:Key"]!))
    };
});
```

Exercise 4: Refresh Token Rotation & Theft Detection

Step 1: Create RefreshToken Entity

Create TmsApi.Domain.Entities/RefreshToken.cs:

```
namespace TmsApi.Domain.Entities;

public class RefreshToken
{
    public int Id { get; set; }
    public string Token { get; set; } = string.Empty;
    public string UserId { get; set; } = string.Empty;
    public DateTime ExpiresAt { get; set; }
    public bool IsUsed { get; set; }
    public bool IsRevoked { get; set; }
}
```

Add `DbSet<RefreshToken> RefreshTokens { get; set; }` to `TmsDbContext.cs` and run migration:

```
dotnet ef migrations add AddRefreshTokens --project TmsApi.Infrastructure/TmsApi.Infrastructure.csproj --startup-project TmsApi.Api/TmsApi.Api.csproj
```

```
dotnet ef database update --project TmsApi.Infrastructure/TmsApi.Infrastructure.csproj --startup-project TmsApi.Api/TmsApi.Api.csproj
```

Step 2: Update AuthController with Token Generation & Rotation

Update `Controllers/AuthController.cs` to inject `TmsDbContext` and `TokenService`, and add `POST /api/auth/refresh`:

```
namespace TmsApi.Api.Controllers;

[ApiController]
[Route("api/[controller]")]
public class AuthController : ControllerBase
{
    private readonly UserManager<TmsUser> _userManager;
    private readonly RoleManager<IdentityRole> _roleManager;
    private readonly TmsDbContext _context;
    private readonly TokenService _tokenService;

    public AuthController(
        UserManager<TmsUser> userManager,
        RoleManager<IdentityRole> roleManager,
        TmsDbContext context,
        TokenService tokenService)
    {
        _userManager = userManager;
        _roleManager = roleManager;
        _context = context;
        _tokenService = tokenService;
    }

    [HttpPost("login")]
    public async Task<IActionResult> Login([FromBody] LoginRequest request)
    {
        var user = await _userManager.FindByEmailAsync(request.Email);
        if (user == null) return Unauthorized(new { detail = "Invalid credentials." });

        if (await _userManager.IsLockedOutAsync(user))
        {

```

```

        return StatusCode(423, new { detail = "Account locked due
to multiple failed login attempts." });
    }

    var validPassword = await _userManager.CheckPasswordAsync(user,
request.Password);
    if (!validPassword)
    {
        await _userManager.AccessFailedAsync(user);
        return Unauthorized(new { detail = "Invalid
credentials." });
    }

    await _userManager.ResetAccessFailedCountAsync(user);

    var roles = await _userManager.GetRolesAsync(user);
    var accessToken = _tokenService.GenerateJwt(user, roles);

    // Issue initial Refresh Token
    var refreshToken = new RefreshToken
    {
        Token = Guid.NewGuid().ToString("N"),
        UserId = user.Id,
        ExpiresAt = DateTime.UtcNow.AddDays(7),
        IsUsed = false,
        IsRevoked = false
    };

    _context.RefreshTokens.Add(refreshToken);
    await _context.SaveChangesAsync();

    return Ok(new
    {
        accessToken,
        refreshToken = refreshToken.Token
    });
}

public record RefreshRequest(string RefreshToken);

[HttpPost("refresh")]
public async Task<IActionResult> Refresh([FromBody] RefreshRequest
request)
{
    var storedToken = await _context.RefreshTokens
.FirstOrDefaultAsync(rt => rt.Token ==
request.RefreshToken);

```

```

        if (storedToken == null)
        {
            return Unauthorized(new { detail = "Invalid refresh
token." });
        }

        // Theft Detection: If an ALREADY-USED token is submitted,
        revoke ALL tokens for this user!
        if (storedToken.IsUsed)
        {
            var userTokens = await _context.RefreshTokens
                .Where(rt => rt.UserId == storedToken.UserId)
                .ToListAsync();

            foreach (var t in userTokens)
            {
                t.IsRevoked = true;
            }

            await _context.SaveChangesAsync();
            return Unauthorized(new { detail = "Token theft detected.
All user sessions revoked." });
        }

        if (storedToken.IsRevoked || storedToken.ExpiresAt <
DateTime.UtcNow)
        {
            return Unauthorized(new { detail = "Refresh token expired
or revoked." });
        }

        // Mark current token as used
        storedToken.IsUsed = true;

        // Issue brand-new Refresh Token pair
        var newRefreshToken = new RefreshToken
        {
            Token = Guid.NewGuid().ToString("N"),
            UserId = storedToken.UserId,
            ExpiresAt = DateTime.UtcNow.AddDays(7),
            IsUsed = false,
            IsRevoked = false
        };

        _context.RefreshTokens.Add(newRefreshToken);
        await _context.SaveChangesAsync();

        var user = await _userManager.FindByIdAsync(storedToken.UserId);

```

```

var roles = await _userManager.GetRolesAsync(user!);
var newAccessToken = _tokenService.GenerateJwt(user!, roles);

return Ok(new
{
    accessToken = newAccessToken,
    refreshToken = newRefreshToken.Token
});
}
}

```

Client Integration Note (Token Migration from M10): Unlike M10's cookie-only transport where the browser implicitly received Set-Cookie, POST /api/auth/login and POST /api/auth/refresh now return { accessToken, refreshToken } explicitly in the JSON response payload. In **Session 3 (Exercise 6)**, we update Angular's AuthService to hold accessToken in memory and configure jwtInterceptor to attach it as Authorization: Bearer <token> to outgoing API requests.

Verification Checkpoint (Session 2)

1. **Login & Claims Inspection:**
 - Send POST /api/auth/login. Confirm response returns accessToken and refreshToken.
 - Copy accessToken to <https://jwt.ms>. Verify claims: sub, email, role, and exp (15 min).
2. **Refresh Token Rotation Check:**
 - Send POST /api/auth/refresh with refreshToken. Confirm a new accessToken and new refreshToken are returned.
3. **Theft Revocation Test:**
 - Resend the *old* (now used) refresh token to POST /api/auth/refresh.
 - Confirm 401 Unauthorized ("Token theft detected. All user sessions revoked.").
 - Verify in database that all RefreshTokens for that user have IsRevoked = 1.